

Strengthening an Inclusive Approach to Supports: *Emerging Practices for Prevocational Services*

June 17, 2015



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Highlights for Today's Discussion

- ✓ Prevocational services in a 21st century system
- ✓ What does history teach us
- ✓ What, where and how (pesky details!)

1

Original intent



2

Where have we ended up?



3

CMS Bulletin – September 2011

CMS Technical Guide – January 2015

- SELN service definitions recommendations
- CMS clarified language
- Questions from states
- Technical Guide:
<http://www.medicaid.gov/Medicaid-CHIP-Program-Information/By-Topics/Waivers/Downloads/Technical-Guidance.pdf>

4

Who is helping answer these questions in your state?

- ✓ Can everyone work?
- ✓ Does everyone have to work?
- ✓ What will people do when they are not working?
- ✓ Won't people get hurt when they lose a job?

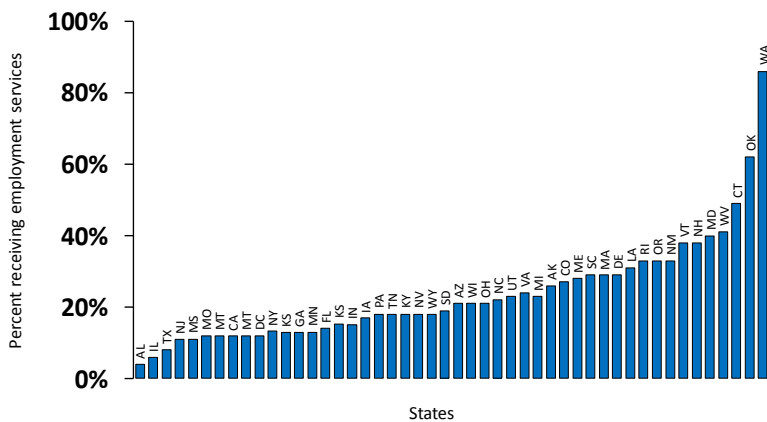
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So Why Focus Here Again?



6

Can Everyone Work?



ICI National Survey of State IDD Agencies 2013



7

Some people experience work in every state.

A lot of people experience work in some states.

What are the goals for all this effort?

8

Guideposts, drivers and influencers

- ✓ Olmstead decision
- ✓ Americans with Disabilities Act
- ✓ Home and Community Based regulations
- ✓ Grassroots energy

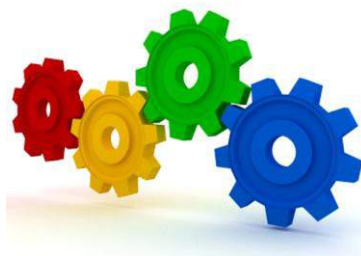


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Why is systems change so challenging?

10

Service definitions
= a strategic tool



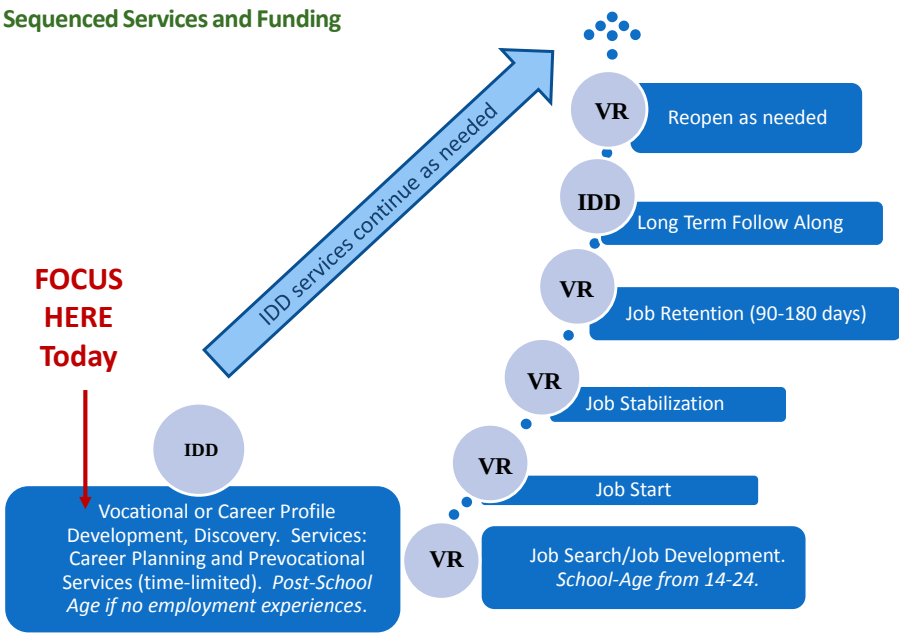
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Prevocational

- ✓ Distinctly different from employment supports
- ✓ What it can not be
- ✓ Where it should be occurring
- ✓ Other names

12

Sequenced Services and Funding



13

Prevocational Services

- ✓ Original intent
- ✓ Has led to decades of “trying”
- ✓ The field is confused
- ✓ Doesn’t work with what’s in HCB Transition Plans
- ✓ New language in Technical Guide

14

Excerpts (Core Service Definition, *page 150*,
January 2015 HCB Instructions, Technical Guide
and Review Criteria)

- Intended outcome is to prepare an individual
for competitive employment

- **Core Service Definition**

15

Other aspects states wrestle with in redesigning this service

- ✓ What is billable
- ✓ What timeframe(s)

Most importantly: Define the outcome

16

What if your state does not have “prevocational” services?

- ✓ Don’t panic! This could be a very good opportunity.
- ✓ Career Planning is an option/alternative.

Remember – the original goal is to help people enter the “employment superhighway” in the most prepared way

17

How are states changing definitions

**Let's hear from YOU – how has
this area impacted the work
you are doing?**

18

Other Considerations

- Relationship between employment services and other services
- What outcomes are to be achieved
- Provider qualifying standards
- Rate and reimbursement methodology
- How is inclusion or integration referenced
- Time limits
- Group sizes and ratios
- Billable and non-billable
- Allowable and not allowable

19

Next Steps

Career Planning

Integrated employment

- Individual
- Group

Day habilitation

20